

A Guide to Setting Up the Development Environment

Introduction

A lot of developers have difficulties setting up a good development environment for themselves on their computers. This really has a great effect on learning and may hinder the growth of learning if the development environment isn't well set up. In this article, I'm going to explain how to set up a development environment using **Github** repositories to deploy your work.

Tools Needed

This is a list of the tools you need to set up your development environment and the following is a brief explanation of what you need each of them for in your development and how each makes work easier:

1. A web browser
2. An editor
3. Git
4. A Github account
5. Node.js and Node Package Manager (npm)
6. Browser-sync

A Web Browser

What is a Web Browser?

A software application used to access information on the World Wide Web is called a **web browser**. When a user requests some information, the web browser fetches the data from a web server and then displays the webpage on the user's screen.

Every windows system comes with a default web browser and that is **Microsoft edge**. Microsoft Edge is a good web browser that is made by **Microsoft** and it has support for the latest HTML version, HTML5 . [...]

An Editor

The editor is your workspace where you write the code for your website. The default editor that comes with the Windows system is **Notepad**. There are many free editors on the internet that are available for download, e.g., Visual Studio Code also known as VSCode, Sublime, Atom, and many more. [...]

Git

Git is a free and open source distributed version control system designed to handle everything from small to very large projects with speed and efficiency.

Git is easy to learn and has a tiny footprint with lightning-fast performance. It outclasses SCM tools like Subversion, CVS, Perforce, and ClearCase with features like cheap local branching, convenient staging areas, and multiple workflows. [...]

A Github account

Github, Inc. is a provider of Internet hosting for software development and version control using Git. It offers the distributed version control and source code management functionality of Git, plus its own features. It provides access control and several collaboration features such as bug tracking, feature requests, task management, continuous integration and Wikis for every project. Headquartered in California, it has been a subsidiary of Microsoft since 2018.

We are going to use Github to set deploy our work.

Nodejs and Node Package Manager (NPM)

Node.js is an open-source, cross-platform, back-end JavaScript runtime environment that runs on the V8 engine and executes JavaScript code outside a web browser. Node.js lets developers use JavaScript to write command line tools and for server-side scripting — running scripts server-side to produce dynamic web page content before the page is sent to the user's web browser. Consequently, Node.js represents a "JavaScript everywhere" paradigm,[6] unifying web-application development around a single programming language, rather than different languages for server-side and client-side scripts.

We need **Node.js** to manage our environment.

Browser-sync

Google Browser Sync was a Mozilla Firefox extension released as freeware from Google. It debuted in Google Labs on 8 June 2006, and in June 2008 was discontinued. [...]

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Note:

Setting up our development environment

Instructions: Make sure you have already downloaded all necessary files needed for this setup

Step 1-

Navigate to your window and search for cmd which is command prompt, open it up and let's get started.

Step 2

Start by checking if the required files are already on your computer.

- To check for git, type git-version into the command line and it will bring the version of git that is on your computer.

- Type in node-version to check for Node and lastly,

- Type in npm-version to check for the node package manager.

You can go on to the next step after confirming all your required files.

Step 3

Download **browser-sync**. To do this, go to the browser-sync website and copy the command line on the page to your command prompt *cmd* to download.

Step 4

Navigate to your browser and login your Github account. After logging in, click on the + sign on the top right corner to create a repository.

Step 5-

Give your repository a name, scroll down a little bit and click **add Readme file** to add a readme file to the repository.

Step 6

Navigate to **settings** then navigate to **pages**. On the pages screen, navigate to sources click on it and change the branch to **main**. Click on **change theme** and it will take you to the Github themes pages. Choose a theme and commit it.

Step 7

Navigate to the home page of your repository and copy the link.

Step 8

Next is to go to your cmd, type **git-clone** then paste in the link and add .git to it to clone it.

Step 9

git-status — is used to check the status of your repository.

mkdir — is used to create a new file.

dir — is used to check the file in your current repository directory.

git-add . — is used to add new files.

git-commit -m "msg" — is used to commit change with a message **msg**.

git-push — is used to push the changes to complete the changes on your Github account.

Step 10

Next is to go to your cmd, type **git-clone** then paste in the link and add .git to it to clone it.

Step 11

Now open your code editor by simply typing code . and start coding

Step 12

Now you're all set up. Check step 9 for the commands you need to get your code published online.

To access the link to your site, go to the repository's settings, navigate to pages and copy the link.

Thanks for reading.

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